



HARVESTING

Both crops can be harvested for their roots or leaves. When roots have reached the desired size, dig them out carefully, since they can be quite brittle; scorzonera roots are prone to “bleed” if damaged.

If roots are left in the ground over winter they will sprout again in spring. Cover the plants with a layer of straw or leaves to blanch new growth. Salsify produces tasty shoots and will resprout two or three times. Blanched scorzonera leaves should be cut when they reach 4 in (10 cm) long, and flowerbuds can also be harvested and eaten.

PESTS AND DISEASES

Both salsify and scorzonera have excellent general pest and disease resistance, but are sometimes prone to white blister disease. This fungus causes white patches to appear on the underside of leaves and creates yellowish patches on the top, causing leaves and flowers to become misshapen. Ensuring that plants are well ventilated, with enough air and space, will help to prevent the spread of this disease. Practice crop rotation to prevent a buildup in the soil. Resistant varieties are available.